

IN THE SENATE

SENATE RESOLUTION NO. 117

BY STATE AFFAIRS COMMITTEE

A SENATE RESOLUTION

STATING FINDINGS OF THE SENATE, RECOGNIZING THE IMPORTANCE OF ITALY AS A
TRADE PARTNER WITH IDAHO, AND SUPPORTING THE STRENGTHENING OF TIES BE-
TWEEN IDAHO AND ITALY.

Be It Resolved by the Senate of the State of Idaho:

WHEREAS, the United States established diplomatic relations with Italy
in 1861 following the unification of most of the peninsula into what became
the Republic of Italy; and

WHEREAS, Italy is an important trade partner with the United States. In
2024, goods exported from the United States to Italy were worth \$32.4 billion
and goods imported to the United States from Italy were worth \$76.3 billion;
and

WHEREAS, Italians have had a presence in Idaho even before Idaho became
a state. Italian immigrants arrived in Idaho beginning in about 1880, re-
sponding to the need for workers to build railroad lines across Idaho. Ital-
ians also became loggers, miners, and farmers in Idaho and were mentioned
in passing in the debates recorded in the proceedings of the Constitutional
Convention of Idaho in 1889-1890; and

WHEREAS, according to Leonard Arrington's "History of Idaho," there
were about 2,627 Italians living and working in Idaho by 1910, including
about 400 families in Pocatello tied to the railroad industry, and also
loggers, farmers, miners, and shopkeepers in the areas of Kellogg, Wallace,
Bonners Ferry, Naples, Lava Hot Springs, Roston, Mullan, and Priest River,
with Priest River even being called "Little Italy" for a time; and

WHEREAS, Italy has long been a partner in trade with the State of Idaho;
and

WHEREAS, Micron Technology, Inc., which was founded in Boise in 1978 as
a four-person semiconductor design company and is now a Fortune 500 company,
now has three sites in Italy, employing over 400 team members in Vimercate,
Arzano, and Avezzano; and

WHEREAS, in 2025, the Honorary Consulate of Italy in Idaho was estab-
lished in Boise by the Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International
Cooperation to provide Italian consulate services in the states of Idaho and
Montana; and

WHEREAS, the establishment of the Honorary Consulate in Idaho is ex-
pected to facilitate an increase in tourism and trade between people and
businesses in Idaho and Italy; to host official visit delegations from
Italy; to promote local cultural events; to facilitate the ability of
students to study abroad; and to help create partnerships with Idaho univer-
sities to facilitate research ventures.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the members of the Senate, assembled
in the Second Regular Session of the Sixty-eighth Idaho Legislature, that

1 the Senate recognizes the importance of Italy as a trade partner with Idaho
2 and supports the strengthening of ties between Idaho and Italy.